

AGAPITO EMANUELE SANTANGELO

Applied Economist · Causal Inference · Digital Methods for Policy Evaluation

Profile

Applied economist working at the intersection of **causal inference** and **digital trace data** for the evaluation of public policies. Combines difference-in-differences designs, machine learning and text mining applied to large-scale web, social media and administrative data. Active research lines cover EU cohesion policy, digital transformation, institutional quality, and the social determinants of health and food insecurity. Publications in *Scientific Reports* and *Accounting, Auditing & Accountability Journal*, with international research experience (Universitat Politècnica de València, 2024).

Research Interests & Methodological Expertise

Research areas: Policy evaluation; EU cohesion and structural funds; Digital divide and digital public services; Institutional quality and governance; Public economics; Health and food security.

Methods: causal inference (*generalized and staggered Difference-in-Differences*, panel data econometrics); machine learning and NLP (*text mining, embeddings, supervised classification* – $AUC \sim 0.91$ on policy-relevant tasks); large-scale digital trace data (*web scraping, social media, high-frequency data*) integrated with administrative micro-data.

Education

PhD in Law and Economics (XXXVIII Cycle) – <i>University of Molise</i> . Public Economics, Policy Evaluation, Development Economics, Data Analytics.	Nov 2022 – Apr 2026
MSc in Management, Entrepreneurship & Innovation (Summa cum laude) – <i>University of Molise</i> . Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Institutional Economics, Econometrics.	Sep 2017 – Apr 2019
Master in Global Marketing Communication & Made in Italy – <i>Italy USA Foundation</i> . International trade, digital strategy, geopolitics.	2019 – 2020

Professional Experience

Research Assistant – <i>Regione Lazio</i> – <i>Regional Statistical System for Policy Support</i> Evaluation of the economic sustainability of Lazio municipalities within the <i>Territorial Public Accounts (CPT)</i> framework.	May 2025 – Present
Data Analysis Strategist – <i>Instant Analytics</i> Advanced analytics on complex datasets to inform strategic decisions and policy recommendations.	Sep 2024 – Present
Research Assistant – PRIN Project – <i>University of Molise</i> Evaluation of the Italian healthcare system in the post-pandemic context: efficiency, equity, territorial disparities.	May 2024 – May 2025
Research Assistant – CIAT Project – <i>University of Molise</i> <i>Food Insecurity Trends</i> project for the International Center for Tropical Agriculture: data-driven analysis of food insecurity drivers and hazards.	Aug 2023 – May 2024
Junior Expert in Policy Evaluation – <i>Eutalia S.p.A.</i> Support to the Managing Authority for the evaluation plan and impact evaluation of <i>PON Research and Innovation 2014–2020</i> .	Apr 2023 – Dec 2023

Teaching

Teaching Assistant – Microeconomics, University of Molise (Dec 2023 – Present).
Lecturer – Digital Economy and Digital Methods, Sviluppo Italia Molise (Feb 2025 – Present).

Skills, Languages, Awards & Advanced Training

Programming & tools: R, Stata, Python, L^AT_EX **Languages:** Italian (native), English (C2), Spanish (B1).
Awards & credentials: Top 1,000 Italian graduates in economics (2019); Chartered Accountant (2022); Statutory Auditor – MEF (2023).
Advanced training: LSE Summer School – *Advanced Econometrics* (Dr. M. Schafgans, Dr. M. Gmeiner) and *Applied Econometrics and Big Data* (Prof. T. Komarova, Dr. M. Schafgans); *Modern Causal Inference* (Prof. J. M. Wooldridge, Prof. P. Sant’Anna); SIdE – *Introductory Econometrics* (Prof. G. Calzolari, 2024) and *Panel Data Econometrics* (Prof. M. E. Bontempi, Prof. R. Golinelli, Dr. I. Mammi, 2024); *Evaluation of Development Policies* (Prof. P. Montalbano, Prof. F. C. Rosati, Prof. C. Pietrobelli, 2023); Harvard Online *Professional Certificate in Data Science* (2023).

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- o Carneiro, B., Resce, G., Caravaggio, N., **Santangelo, A. E.**, Ruscica, G., Tucci, G., ... & Coffey, K. (2025). *Text mining and machine learning reveal global determinants of food insecurity*. **Scientific Reports**, 15(1), 36709. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Pastore, L., Corvo, L., **Santangelo, A. E.**, Resce, G., & Lelo, A. (2025). *Measuring sustainability impacts through SROI: a case study of the Italian glass industry's contribution to the SDGs*. **Accounting, Auditing & Accountability Journal**, 38(5), 1483–1498. [\[Link\]](#)
- o **Santangelo, A. E.** (2023). *The relationship between financial constraints and innovation, with a supportive analysis on a sample of firms*. **Journal of Academic Research in Economics**, 15(3), 523–544. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Pietrovito, F., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2022). *Divario Nord-Sud: un focus sul Molise*. **GLOCALE**, 18(19). [\[Link\]](#)

Working Papers

- o Pietrovito, F., Rancan, A., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2026). *Do Fiscal Constraints Affect Health Inequality Research? A Bibliometric Perspective*. ESDP No. 26102, University of Molise. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Caravaggio, N., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2025). *EU Cohesion Policy and Digital Public Services*. ESDP No. 25100, University of Molise. [\[Link\]](#)

Conference Papers

- o Cebrián Cerdá, E., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Domenech, J. (2025). *Are people losing interest in environmental issues? Insights from Google Trends*. CARMA 2025, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Nigro, I., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Modina, M. (2025). *Detecting potential fake innovators using web scraping: the case for Italian startup*. CARMA 2025, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Caravaggio, N., Di Renzo, G., Fanelli, L., Resce, G., & **Santangelo, A. E.** (2024). *In What is Europe Investing? A Text Mining Approach on Cohesion Projects*. CARMA 2024, Valencia. [\[Link\]](#)
- o Carneiro, B., Resce, G., Tucci, G., Ruscica, G., Caravaggio, N., Fanelli, L., **Santangelo, A. E.**, & Cruciata, P. (2024). *A multi-platform framework for nowcasting social phenomena: a case study for food insecurity*. CARMA 2024, Valencia. [\[Link\]](#)
- o **Santangelo, A. E.** (2024). *Do websites provide information about innovation activities?* CARMA 2024, Valencia, p. 411. [\[Link\]](#)

Policy Reports & Dissemination

- o *PON Research and Innovation 2014–2020 – Final Evaluation Report, Action I.2 “Attracting and International Mobility of Researchers”*. [\[Link\]](#)
- o *Eticaeconomia: In cosa investe l’Unione Europea? Un’analisi di Text Mining sui progetti di coesione*. [\[Link\]](#)
- o *Eticaeconomia: Il PNRR nella comunicazione istituzionale dei comuni*. [\[Link\]](#)

Conferences & Workshops

- o **Understanding and Addressing Digital Inequalities** – Annual Scientific Conference on Digital Democracy, *Centre for a Digital Society, Robert Schuman Centre, European University Institute (EUI)*, Florence, 20–21 November 2025. *Presenter*.
- o **SIE 2025** – 66th Annual Scientific Meeting of the *Italian Economic Association (Società Italiana di Economia)*, Università di Napoli Parthenope, 23–25 October 2025. *Presenter*.
- o **AISRe 2025** – XLVI Annual Scientific Conference of the *Italian Regional Science Association (RSAI Italian Section)*, Università “G. d’Annunzio” Chieti-Pescara, 10–12 September 2025. *Presenter*.
- o **CARMA 2025** – 7th Int. Conf. on Advanced Research Methods and Analytics, Rome, 2–4 July 2025. *Organizer & Presenter*.
- o **CARMA 2024** – 6th Int. Conf. on Advanced Research Methods and Analytics, Valencia. *Organizer & Presenter*.
- o **HEAd’24** – 10th Int. Conf. on Higher Education Advances. *Organizer*.
- o **SoFIA 2024** – 2nd Workshop on Social Health Frailty as Determinants of Inequality in Ageing. *Presenter*.

Editorial Activity – Reviewer

- o *The Annals of Regional Science* (Springer).
- o *Italian Economic Journal* (Springer).
- o *Research in International Business and Finance* (Elsevier).
- o *Journal of Infrastructure, Policy and Development*.